



When Everything Feels Like Too Much

A practical guide for when you're overwhelmed

by Don James · hotcoffeewithdon.com

Hey.

I wrote this at 2am when I needed it myself. It's short, honest, and there's no toxic positivity in it. If you're reading this, something is probably hard right now. That's okay. Let's get through the next few minutes.

This guide has five sections. You don't have to read them in order. Go to whatever you need.

1. If You're in Crisis Right Now

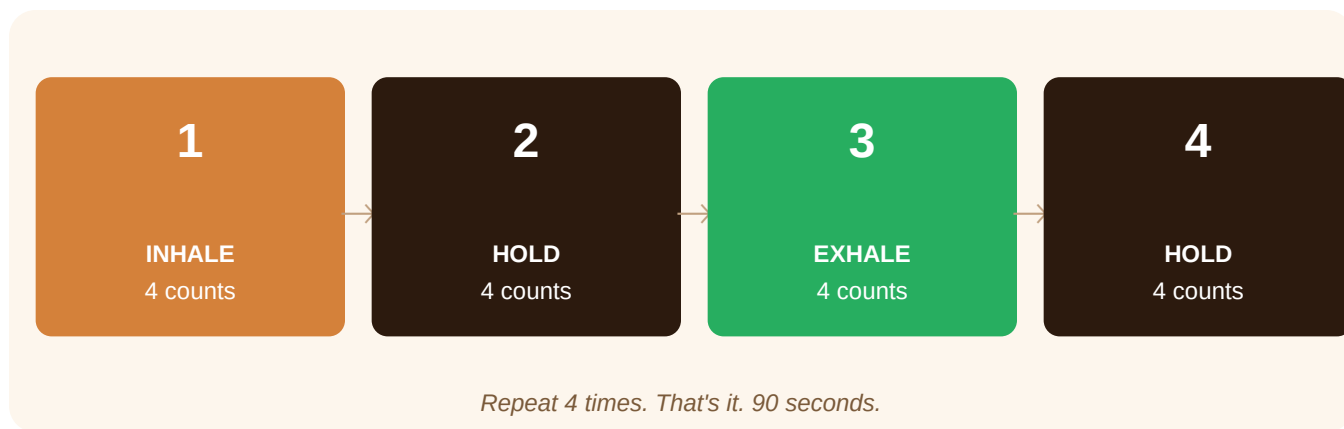
If you're thinking about hurting yourself or someone else, please reach out now:

- **988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline** — call or text 988
- **Crisis Text Line** — text HOME to 741741
- **International:** findahelpline.com

You don't have to be "suicidal enough" to call. If you're struggling, that's enough.

2. Box Breathing (Do This First)

When your nervous system is fired up, your brain can't think straight. This resets it in about 90 seconds. It's used by Navy SEALs and also by me, in my car, in parking lots. No judgment.



3. The 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Technique

When you're spiraling, this pulls you back into your body and out of your head. Works for anxiety, panic attacks, dissociation, and "staring at the ceiling at 3am" situations.

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Things you can SEE

Look around. Name them.

Step 1: Write down everything that feels overwhelming.

Step 2: Circle the 3 most important things on that list.

Step 3: Cross out everything else. Those don't exist today.

Step 4: Of the 3, pick the ONE you'll do in the next hour.

Everything else can wait. I promise.

This works because overwhelm is almost always a prioritization problem, not a capacity problem. You can handle more than you think — you just can't handle everything at once.

5. When You Need a Human

Sometimes a guide isn't enough. Sometimes you just need to talk to a real person who isn't going to panic or judge you or immediately tell you to see a therapist (though therapists are great, for the record).

That's what I'm here for. Book a free 10-minute call. No prep needed. No agenda. Just show up and